

PRODUCT & EXPERIENCE DESIGN DOCUMENT

Project	Windows 95 Personal Portfolio Web App
Document	Product & Experience Design Document
Version	1.0 — Initial Draft
Date	May 21, 2026

1. Vision Statement

"A personal portfolio that feels like opening someone's real computer — not a website about them."

The goal is to replace the typical portfolio page (hero image, scrolling sections, contact form at the bottom) with an environment that tells a story through exploration. Visitors discover the owner's work, personality, and contact info at their own pace by poking around a simulated Windows 95 desktop. The medium is the message: someone who built a fully working OS simulation for their portfolio clearly knows how to ship creative, technical work.

2. Target Audience

Audience	Description	Goal
Primary	Recruiters & hiring managers at design-forward or engineering-forward companies	Impress, be remembered; get contacted
Secondary	Fellow developers & designers who appreciate craft	Organic sharing; community cred
Tertiary	Personal network — warm introductions	Quick overview; easy contact link

3. Core Design Principles

Authenticity First

Every pixel must feel like it could have shipped in 1995. The 3D bevel borders, silver backgrounds, teal desktop, and pixel-art icons must be correct. No rounded cards, no gradient overlays, no modern typefaces.

Reward Exploration

The casual visitor who only opens 'About Me' gets the content they need. The curious visitor who opens every app, right-clicks the desktop, and reads every menu item gets easter eggs, jokes, and personality.

Never Break the Illusion

Error messages look like Win95 dialogs. Loading states look like progress bars. The clock ticks in real time. The Shut Down screen actually shuts down.

Functional Toys

MSPaint actually paints. Minesweeper actually mines. Solitaire actually deals. These are working apps, not decorations — they make people stay longer and leave remembering the experience.

4. User Journey

```
[ First Visit ]
|
v
[ Boot Sequence ] ~8 seconds (skippable on repeat visits)
BIOS POST -> 'Starting Windows 95...' -> splash -> desktop fade-in
|
v
[ Desktop ]
```

```
Visitor sees: teal wallpaper | desktop icons | taskbar
|
+---> [ Start Menu ] Programs -> any app
|
+---> [ Desktop Icon double-click ]
|
+-- About Me -> Learn who this person is
+-- Portfolio -> Browse their work
+-- Contact -> Get in touch
+-- MS Paint -> Draw something fun
+-- CD Player -> Listen while browsing
+-- Notepad -> Find the easter-egg readme
+-- Minesweeper -> Play while thinking it over
+-- Solitaire -> Classic procrastination
+-- Internet Explorer -> Geocities-era parody page
+-- Recycle Bin -> Hidden surprises
```

5. Application Designs

5.1 About Me

Window Title: About Me — System Properties

Mimics a Win95 System Properties dialog. A 64x64 pixel-art avatar sits on the left. A tab panel on the right contains:

Tab	Content
General	Name, role, tagline, 3-4 sentence bio. Below it: a fake System Properties block — 'Processor: Coffee-driven, 2.4GHz RAM: 64MB'.
Skills	Win95 checklist (checkbox per skill, checked = proficient). Categories: Languages, Frameworks, Tools, Soft Skills. A few hidden.
Experience	File-list timeline: [icon] Company — Role — Year. Clicking a row opens a small info bubble with a short description.

Easter Egg: Clicking the pixel-art avatar 5 times plays the Win95 startup sound and shows a dialog: 'You found me. Please hire me. [OK]'

5.2 Portfolio

Window Title: Portfolio — Windows Explorer

Fully mimics Windows Explorer. Left panel: folder tree. Right panel: file grid.

```
Left Panel (folder tree):
My Projects
Web Development
Design Work
Open Source
Side Projects
Case Studies
Awards & Press

Right Panel (file grid):
Each project = a file icon. Type communicates stack:
.html Web project | .psd Design | .exe App | .txt Writing
Double-click -> Project Detail window (thumbnail + desc + links)
```

View modes (Large Icons / List / Details) are all functional via toolbar toggles. Details view adds columns: Name, Type, Date Modified, Size (LOC or fictional). Status bar: 'X object(s). 1 selected.'

5.3 Contact

Window Title: Contact — Outlook Express (parody)

Mimics a stripped-down email client. A compose area is open by default with To: pre-filled (owner's email) and Subject: pre-filled 'Hey, I'd like to connect!' The body is an editable textarea. Send opens a mailto: link + shows a 'Sending...' progress dialog then 'Message Sent! [OK]'.

A read-only inbox is visible behind the compose pane with fake messages: 'From: Bill Gates — Nice portfolio, kid.' | 'From: Mom — Are you eating enough?' Social links rendered as Address Book entries (GitHub, LinkedIn, etc.).

5.4 MS Paint

Window Title: untitled - Paint

Region	Details
Toolbar (left)	2-col icon grid: Pencil, Brush, Fill, Text, Select, Line, Rectangle, Ellipse, Eyedropper, Eraser. Cursor changes per tool.
Canvas	600x400 default, white. All drawing is live — no layers, no alpha. Zoom: 50% / 100% / 200%.
Color Palette (bottom)	28-color grid matching original Win95 MSPaint. Left-click = foreground. Right-click = background. Two preview squares.
Brush Size Panel	4 options: 1px, 3px, 5px, 8px dot previews.
Menu: File	New (confirm dialog) Save As (disabled — activation joke dialog) Print (browser print)
Menu: Edit	Undo (Ctrl+Z, up to 20) Redo (Ctrl+Y) Select All Clear Image
Menu: Image	Flip Horizontal (functional) Invert Colors (functional) Crop to Selection
Status Bar	Cursor coordinates (X, Y) Canvas dimensions Selection size when active

Save Easter Egg: File > Save As shows a Win95 activation dialog: 'Save feature requires Windows 95 activation. Please call 1-800-555-HIRE.'

5.5 Audio Player (CD Player)

Window Title: CD Player

Styled as the Windows 98 CD Player accessory — compact, dark chrome, LED display showing scrolling track title. Controls:

- Play / Pause / Stop / Previous Track / Next Track
- Volume slider (functional via Howler.js)
- Shuffle toggle and Repeat (none / one / all)
- Time display: elapsed and remaining (MM:SS)
- A small track visualizer: animated green frequency bars (CSS animation or Canvas)
- Playlist view (expandable): track list with double-click to jump

Music: Portfolio owner provides royalty-free MP3/OGG files placed in /assets/music/. Recommended sources: Pixabay, Free Music Archive, or the owner's own compositions.

5.6 Notepad

Window Title: README.TXT — Notepad | Pre-loaded with a quirky developer readme — jokes about the codebase, imaginary contributors, fake table of contents. Fully editable by the visitor. Find (Ctrl+F) is functional. Time/Date (F5) inserts real timestamp. Typing 'iddqd' anywhere and pressing Enter triggers a Doom-style 'GOD MODE ACTIVATED' dialog.

5.7 Minesweeper

Window Title: Minesweeper | Full Klondike-correct Minesweeper. Left-click to reveal. Right-click to flag/question-mark. First click is guaranteed safe (mines placed after first click). Cascade-reveal for zero-neighbor cells. Difficulties: Beginner 9x9/10, Intermediate 16x16/40, Expert 30x16/99, Custom. High scores persisted in localStorage. Smiley face = 😊 on win, 😞 on loss.

5.8 Solitaire

Window Title: Solitaire | Standard Klondike. Draw 1 or Draw 3 (selectable). Drag-and-drop cards. Auto-complete when all cards are face-up. Win animation: classic cascading bouncing cards — cards arc off the screen and bounce. This animation is non-negotiable and cannot be skipped. Two card back styles under Game > Deck.

5.9 Internet Explorer (Parody)

Window Title: Welcome to the Internet — Microsoft Internet Explorer

URL	What it shows
www.aboutme.com	Geocities-era parody of the About Me content: garish tiled background, marquee text, 'Under Construction' (rotating)
www.hotjobs.com	Parody job board showing one listing: the portfolio owner's ideal role — pre-filled and funny.
www.google.com	A 'Google' homepage circa 1998 with a search box. Anything typed returns: 'Did you mean: hire [Owner Name]'
Unknown URLs	Classic 'The page cannot be displayed' error — pixel-perfect recreation of the original IE error page.

5.10 Recycle Bin

Window Title: Recycle Bin | Appears empty on first open. Right-clicking an item shows 'Restore' and 'Delete Permanently'. Hidden content: a 'deleted' file called 'my_old_resume.doc' — opening it shows a hilariously bad first-draft resume from an imaginary early career: Objective: 'To obtain employment.' Skills: 'Microsoft Word (advanced).'

6. Desktop Environment Details

6.1 Wallpaper

Default: Classic Windows 95 teal (#008080). The owner may replace this with a personal .BMP-style wallpaper (tiled or centered). Right-clicking the desktop shows a context menu: 'Arrange Icons | Refresh | Properties'. Properties opens a fake Display Settings dialog.

6.2 Desktop Icons

Icon	Label	App	Position (approx)
My Computer	My Computer	Fake My Computer (info about the site/status)	Top-left
My Projects	My Projects	Portfolio	Below My Computer
About Me	About Me	About Me	Below My Projects
Inbox (1)	Contact	Contact	Below About Me
untitled.bmp	untitled.bmp	MSPaint	Right column, top
cd-player	CD Player	Audio Player	Right column
IE	Internet Explorer	Fake IE	Bottom-left (near taskbar)
Recycle Bin	Recycle Bin	Recycle Bin	Bottom-right

```
[ Start ]  
Programs >  
About Me  
Portfolio  
Contact  
Accessories >  
MS Paint  
CD Player  
Notepad  
Games >  
Minesweeper  
Solitaire  
Internet Explorer  
  
Settings (dummy submenu)  
Help (opens Notepad easter-egg README)  
Run... (dialog: type a command, always responds with an error joke)  
  
Shut Down... (modal with Shut Down / Restart / Suspend options)
```

Trigger	Effect
About Me Avatar x5	Win95 startup sound + 'You found me. Please hire me. [OK]'
Notepad: type 'iddqd' + Enter	DOOM-style 'GOD MODE ACTIVATED' alert dialog
MSPaint: File > Save As	'Activation required. Call 1-800-555-HIRE.'
Recycle Bin	Fake old resume with embarrassing early-career content
Fake IE: any unknown URL	Custom 'page cannot be displayed' parody
Fake IE: google.com search	'Did you mean: hire [Owner Name]?'
Shut Down executed	Fade-to-black + 'Safe to turn off' screen; click to reload
Start > Run...	Type anything, always get: 'Bad command or file name.'
Right-click desktop > Properties	Fake Display Settings dialog that does nothing
Minesweeper first-click guarantee	Small tooltip: 'First click is always safe. Unlike job hunting.'

Sound	Trigger	File
Startup	Desktop fade-in complete (first visit)	startup.mp3 — classic Win95 chime
Error	Any error dialog opening	error.mp3 — the iconic 3-note dun-dun-dun
Click	Window open / close	click.mp3 — soft click
Minimize	Window minimize	minimize.mp3
Maximize	Window maximize/restore	restore.mp3
Shut Down	Shut Down selected	shutdown.mp3

Tada	Solitaire win animation starts	tada.mp3
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All sounds are gated by a user gesture (browser autoplay policy). A small speaker icon in the system tray allows global mute. All sound files must be sourced as royalty-free or self-created.

9. Accessibility

- All window control buttons (┐, ■, X) have aria-label attributes.
- Modal dialogs (Shut Down, errors) implement focus trapping — Tab cycles only within the dialog.
- Keyboard shortcuts: Alt+F4 closes focused window. Win key toggles Start Menu. Arrow keys navigate Start Menu items.
- Win95's color palette is historically low-contrast. A 'Modern Mode' toggle in Display Properties (or Settings) switches to higher-contrast equivalents.
- Screen reader: landmark roles (main, navigation, complementary) are applied to desktop, taskbar, and window regions.

10. Content Checklist (Owner to Provide)

Item	Description	Used In
Bio text	2-4 sentences, first person, casual tone	About Me > General
Pixel-art avatar	64x64 PNG, transparent bg	About Me
Skills list	Categorized: Languages / Frameworks / Tools	About Me > Skills
Work history	Company, role, dates, 1-sentence description each	About Me > Experience
Projects	Name, stack, description, screenshot (optional), URL	Portfolio
Contact email	Displayed in Contact app To: field	Contact
Social links	GitHub, LinkedIn, Twitter/X (optional)	Contact
Music files	3-10 royalty-free MP3/OGG tracks	CD Player
Custom wallpaper	Optional .BMP or .PNG (tiled or centered)	Desktop
Win95 sounds	Royalty-free startup/error/shutdown sounds	System-wide